



STATUS REPORT

Angola — digital transformation and data governance status report

Edition of 2026-09-05 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

Angola's cybersecurity strategy sets the creation of three institutions as its own strategic actions, and the executive built them by decree rather than through the legislative reform the same document commits to. [Presidential Decree 256/25 of 3 December 2025](#) approved the strategy, grounded in Law 7/17 and organised around six strategic objectives, and it makes creating the National Cybersecurity Council, the National Cybersecurity Centre and CERT.ao those strategic actions, while separately committing to a two-phase legislative reform whose first phase is passage of laws by the legislature. Presidential Decree 258/25 created the Conselho Nacional de Cibersegurança as a 21-member consultative body chaired by the President on the same day.

What the strategy has not yet produced is the operational floor. Designation of telecommunications as critical infrastructure, mandatory incident reporting, and a national cyber-incident-response team with emergency mechanisms to preserve continuity of communications in a crisis were supplied by no instrument in force as at 10 August 2026. The government's first on-the-record answer to the national carrier's cyberattack, given to the National Assembly on 31 July 2026, was that the existing programme to reinforce technological infrastructure will help the country protect itself.

Above cybersecurity sits a fuller stack of commitments. The [White Paper on Information and Communication Technologies 2023-2027](#) is the approved ICT strategy, setting e-governance policy and interoperability and security requirements for public-administration platforms. The 2025 GovTech assessment records a current digital transformation strategy, an established institution with a mandate for digital government and a data-governance function held by an autonomous institution and taken across government rather than sector by sector, with delivery of the digital transition agenda for public administration coordinated by the Instituto de Modernização Administrativa under the Casa Civil. The named hole is artificial intelligence: UNESCO's readiness assessment, presented on 30 June 2026, put the absence of a National AI Strategy as the principal gap, alongside deficits in human capital and interministerial coordination.

The administrative base under all of it is improving from a low level: Angola scores 43.8 out of 100 for overall governance, 36th of 54 African states and below the continental average of 49.3 (2023), and Budgetary and Financial Management is its most deteriorated measure of the decade, down 13.9 points to 44.4 (2023).

Legislation and regulation

Angola's newest binding digital statute punishes what people post: Lei n.º 6/26 was gazetted in Diário da República I Série n.º 146 and took effect on 4 August 2026, carrying one to three years' imprisonment for publishing false information, three to eight where the content incites hatred or damages a reputation, and up to ten where it compromises electoral processes or state security.

The cybersecurity statute has passed parliament and is not yet law. The National Assembly adopted the presidentially-initiated bill on 12 August 2026 by 104 votes to 56, the governing party for and the opposition against with no abstentions, directing it at the protection of networks, critical infrastructure and essential services through prevention, detection, incident response and restoration of affected systems. It had passed in generality on 23 January 2026 by 105 votes to one with 75 abstentions, been suspended in committee on 7–8 July 2026 over drafting non-conformities in the preamble and first two chapters, returned to clause-by-clause debate on 3 August and cleared the joint committee on 7 August 2026 by 23 votes to none with 10 abstentions. Its penalties are set in multiples of the national minimum wage rather than in kwanza, running from seven to 70 for individuals on the lightest administrative infringements up to 500 for individuals and 4,000 for legal persons on the most serious. It obliges telecommunications operators to transmit any communication whose content is criminal or prejudicial to state security, a duty the opposition and part of civil society object to on the ground that neither the qualifying content nor the circumstances in which a subscriber's personal data reaches the authorities is defined. No promulgation, gazette number or entry-into-force date is on file. The Council and Centre it would create had already been created by presidential decree two months before that first vote.

The electronic-signature regime will arrive as an executive instrument. Angola has no dedicated legal regime for electronic signatures, digital certification or public key infrastructure, and the National Assembly approved in generality on 30 July 2026, by 166 votes in favour with none against, the President's request for legislative authorisation to legislate it; the authorisation runs for 90 days from publication of the authorising law.

Three further texts are in the pipeline and none is law. A complete draft artificial-intelligence law went out for public consultation in September 2025; it regulates a single class of system, "IA Crítica", leaves the competent authority to a future regulation, and repeals nothing. A digital government law entered public consultation on 6 May 2026, and a first dedicated identity-data-processing regime reached the Council of Ministers on 29 April 2026. What binds meanwhile is Law 23/11 on electronic communications, 7/17 on network and computer systems protection, 2/20 on video-surveillance, 11/20 on cellular location and electronic surveillance, and the Criminal Code 38/20.

Data protection

Angola's data-protection authority fines, and the sums are rising. In deliberations reported in June 2026 the Agência de Protecção de Dados fined two technology firms more than Kz 600m between them – Crescer Tech US\$505,000 for notification and authorisation failures and for transferring client data to cloud servers outside Angola, and Fast Digital Center US\$112,000 for inadequate security measures. Those follow sanctions divulged in September 2025 against TAAG at US\$100,000 and the Banco de Desenvolvimento de Angola at US\$75,000.

The instrument behind that is Law 22/11, the omnibus statute setting processing principles, regulating sensitive data including biometric and genetic data, and establishing the authority with notification and authorisation powers. It gives the regulator real teeth: it applies fines itself, its deliberations become executive titles, and refusing the collaboration it requires is a crime. Operators must also notify it of any breach compromising personal data, and Circular 2/2024 of October 2024 sets out what an incident report must contain.

The regulator's independence is thinner than its powers. Every seat on its board is a presidential appointment, any member may be exonerated at any time by decree with no stated grounds or procedure, and the whole board may be dissolved on a change of orientation about its management — including the three members the National Assembly elects and the judge elected by the Conselho Superior da Magistratura Judicial. Superintendence has sat since the first board was sworn in with the telecommunications ministry, which also oversees the operators whose processing it polices.

State processing largely sits outside the regime. Authorisation is dispensed with wherever processing derives from a legal instrument, and processing under the rules on state secrecy, state security and segredo de justiça falls outside the law altogether. Lei n.º 11/20 gives the authority only knowledge and monitoring of the criminal police database, permits cross-matching against other databases and against private, commercial and residential video-surveillance, and obliges those cameras' owners to give the police access. Amnesty International's Security Lab confirmed Predator spyware on an Angolan journalist's phone on 4 May 2024, naming the state intelligence service SINSE as its end-user. Identity data is outside the surveillance regime as well as the protection one: the South African research organisation Intelwatch's field report of 8 August 2026 found no rule stating when the intelligence service may obtain identity, biometric or mobility data and no independent body to review such requests, and the migration service confirmed at the Santa Clara border post that SINSE may request access under established protocols. The same report puts the national biometric border-control system at US\$112m, awarded in February 2025 to Dolinveste Lda with Poland's Technology for Business, on its account by direct award rather than open tender, and a further EUR 130m passport and biometric identity contract with Hungary's ANY Security Printing, taking the total past US\$250m without significant tender, parliamentary scrutiny or human-rights impact assessment; it records no biometric system operating at the border posts with the Democratic Republic of the Congo, crossings there regulated by a manually checked seven-day paper pass, and the one functional post, Santa Clara, reading passports against the migration database with fingerprint and height capture discontinued on maintenance grounds. The figures and the characterisation of the awards are Intelwatch's; no procurement record is on file.

Regional collaboration

The part of Angola's digital estate that has actually crossed a border is its satellite. Mozambique's Boane Earth Station is receiving the ANGOSAT-2 signal under space and digital cooperation memoranda signed in June 2026; an ICT memorandum with Namibia, signed at ANGOTIC 2026 in Luanda, covers cybersecurity cooperation and training alongside satellite connectivity, following an ANGOSAT-2 proof of concept run in Namibia in October 2025; and the space agency GGPEN signed a space-science cooperation agreement with Nigeria's NASRDA at the same event on 13 June 2026.

On treaties the record is one ratified and one pending. Angola ratified the African Union Convention on Cyber Security and Personal Data Protection, approving it by Resolution 33/19 of 9 July 2019 and completing ratification by presidential letter in 2020, and has signed the UN Convention against Cybercrime, with ratification outstanding as at 3 March 2026.

Its main multilateral digital programme is not wholly its own to steer. Angola is a Phase I country of the COMESA-coordinated IDEA harmonisation programme, with the Instituto de Modernização Administrativa as national focal point, and its Digital Acceleration Project is one national slice of a five-state programme with the DRC, Zambia, Malawi and Eswatini whose third steering committee met in Lusaka on 30 July 2026. As at April 2025 Angola was the laggard of that cohort, its project not yet effective while the COMESA and Malawi projects already were. The programme's inaugural forum in Lusaka on 29 July 2026 recommended harmonisation of member states' digital policies.

Luanda is also hosting the traffic. SADC's third preparatory meeting for the ITU World Radiocommunication Conference 2027 opened there on 3 August 2026, five days of member-state experts on spectrum management, regional integration, connectivity and network resilience. The data-protection authority signed its first memorandum with a non-African regulator on 18 September 2025, committing to mutual assistance with Brazil's Autoridade Nacional de Proteção de Dados at the Global Privacy Assembly in Seoul. Against all of that, Regional Integration remains among Angola's ten worst-scoring governance measures at 21.2 out of 100 (2023), 48th of 54 African states despite membership of both ECCAS and SADC.

The treaty commitments underneath are older and lighter than the programmes. The National Assembly approved the African Union Convention on Cyber Security and Personal Data Protection by Resolução n.º 33/19 of 9 July 2019, and no deposit of an instrument of ratification is on record. In the Lusophone frame, Angola signed the CPLP Charter of Rights and Principles in Digital Environments at São Tomé on 19 July 2024 with all nine member states — expressly declaratory and non-binding, committing signatories to meaningful connectivity on non-discriminatory and affordable terms, personal data protection, cybersecurity cooperation, digital literacy and non-fragmentation of the digital environment, and condemning blanket internet shutdowns, and its regulators joined a Maputo workshop in December 2025 where UNESCO launched the Portuguese edition of its Data Governance Toolkit and more than 40 data-protection authorities and ICT regulators from Angola, Guinea-Bissau, São Tomé and Príncipe and Mozambique mapped national data ecosystems against the African Union Data Policy Framework and the Smart Africa Data Governance Blueprint. No domestic measure is recorded as taken under any of them.

Standards

Angola has a national standards body and it works by catalogue rather than by mandate. The quality-infrastructure institute formed by the 2021 merger of the standardisation and accreditation bodies is an ISO correspondent member, a category carrying no vote on technical work, and published a 2026 national standards catalogue incorporating 140 new standards, many from SADC regional harmonisation, stating that Angolan standards are voluntary and become mandatory only where legislation in the public interest makes them so. The one standard the state has legislated for its own data is geographic: Lei n.º 8/25 fixes unique sequential alphanumeric codes for the country, its 21 provinces, 326 municipalities and 378 communes, on criteria the law says are drawn from ISO standards expressly to ease data exchange between national and international systems, leaving codes vacated by an abolished unit permanently unassigned.

The most exactly specified technical standard Angola publishes governs closed-circuit cameras. The video-surveillance regulation fixes IP66 and IK-10 housings, H.264/H.265 encoding, native TCP/IP with IPv6, Full HD 1080p at 60 frames per second, 36x optical zoom and programmable privacy masks, with all transmission encrypted and keys rotated every six months, and specifies the mandatory warning sign down to its pictogram, its wording and a mounting height no lower than 1.50 m.

Government interoperability is older and thinner. Presidential Decree 46/18 approved PNAGIA, the national plan for a global interoperability architecture across central and local state administration, establishing technical guidelines and a platform for data sharing between government bodies, and the 2025 GovTech assessment records that framework and a Government Service Bus in place but only partially used across public bodies. The institute procuring the replacement has now put a number on how partial: its 2026 terms of reference disclose a seven-month study across 25 public institutions finding only 27% of systems interconnected, with integration predominantly point-to-point. On trust services the floor is missing rather than partial: no public key infrastructure has been established, so the chip in the national identity card cannot be used for digital authentication.

Where published standards do bind, they bind through the tax and payments rails. Electronic invoices must be issued from software certified by the tax authority, transmitted in real time and reported with a verification code, on SAF-T as the underlying data standard, and the central bank has completed the migration of domestic payments to the ISO 20022 international messaging standard.

Regulatory practice is being built with outside help, and the state's own document handling still slips. Portugal's telecommunications regulator ANACOM, working with the EU Delegation, ran an institutional-strengthening mission in March 2026 to train INACOM in digital-sector regulation. MINTTICS republished its 2025 procurement plan on 5 March 2025, keeping the same 29 projects but correcting the ministry total from Kz 616.7 biliões – larger than Angola's entire 2025 state budget – to Kz 225.6 mil milhões.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

Angola scores far better on digital freedom than on the freedom of its press: Digital Freedom is one of its ten best-scoring governance measures at 70.9 out of 100 (2023), 19th of 54 African states, while Media Freedom fell 2.7 points over 2014-2023 to 45.1 out of 100, 38th of 54, and Freedom of Expression and Belief fell 1.3 points to 49.2, 35th of 54 – both moving against the country's overall governance improvement.

The newest instrument bears on the first of those. The law governing what Angolans may publish online took effect on 4 August 2026; UNITA voted against it on the ground that the text opens the way to criminalising journalists and ordinary users, while the MPLA framed it as combating structured disinformation. The same argument runs through the cybersecurity bill, where opponents warn it could become an instrument of abusive surveillance and digital repression without strong judicial guarantees, against the responsible minister calling it strategically important.

Consultation on digital law is real and recent – the artificial-intelligence bill was published in full on the telecommunications ministry's consultation portal, and the digital government bill went out for consultation on 6 May 2026 – and the Assembly does settle digital questions in the open, rejecting a UNITA bill to open the electoral personal-data registers in plenary on 25 June 2026 on the argument that it would expose sensitive data without consent. The standing machinery is weaker than the set-piece. Angola has an online public participation platform, with a separate portal handling petitions, and a citizen feedback mechanism for public services that lacks every one of the supporting capabilities the 2025 assessment tests for.

Access to the record is the binding constraint. A right to information law is graded as in force rather than adopted and dormant (2025), but disclosure of public records is among Angola's worst-scoring governance measures, and the documentation behind most assessed government systems and oversight functions – the interoperability framework, the national service portal, the digital government mandate, the transformation strategy and the data-protection authority's reporting – is held internally and not published.

Finance

MoUs and other agreements

Angola's national government cloud originates in a memorandum rather than a contract: the Angola–United Arab Emirates agreement of December 2021, whose five agreed heads as the telecoms ministry set them out are a three-year digitalisation master plan for Angola, public-private partnerships, build-operate-transfer and other financing channels, digital skills and workforce development, and further projects of mutual interest. It was operationalised between MINTTICS and the Abu Dhabi big-data firm Presight, which signed its own memorandum with the government the same month to develop a transformation programme for "Digital Angola".

The ANGOTIC conference in June 2026 produced a further cluster of agreements: GGPEN and Africell on expanding ANGOSAT-2 services, Eutelsat and the Angolan provider Mercury Telecom on multi-year LEO capacity, Telecom Namibia and GGPEN on a pilot for ANGOSAT-2 capacity, alongside a ministerial ICT cooperation memorandum between the two countries, and Unitel and Angola Telecom on infrastructure sharing in underserved border regions.

State-to-state and regulator-to-regulator instruments run alongside. The data protection authority and Brazil's ANPD signed on technical assistance, regulation and supervision in September 2025; the Banco Nacional de Angola and the DRC's central bank signed on payment-system interoperability and cheaper cross-border payments in July 2026; a digital-governance pact was signed with Cape Verde in March 2026; and ICT cooperation with Kenya was agreed at the Luanda Financing Summit in November 2025. Memoranda signed under the digital transition agenda cover broadband, digital inclusion and the national digital-identity system.

The largest sum any private party has attached to Angola's digital estate also rests on a framework: the Cybastion and Angola Telecom investment announced in June 2025 sits on a memorandum of understanding signed at Mobile World Congress in Barcelona in March 2025.

New investments

The World Bank's US\$300 million loan for the Angola Digital Acceleration Project had disbursed US\$112.21 million, 37.40 per cent of the total, by the Bank's [fourth supervision report \(June 2026\)](#), against a closing date of March 2030. That is a recovery from a standing start: the loan was approved in June 2024 and signed that October, yet was [still not effective in March 2025, with nothing disbursed beyond US\\$1 million drawn from a preparation advance](#) and both its outcome and implementation ratings cut to Moderately Unsatisfactory, before the Bank [restored them to Moderately Satisfactory in June 2026](#). The money is appropriated [US\\$100m to connectivity and inclusion, US\\$122.25m to inclusive and safe digital public infrastructure, US\\$54m to productive digital usage and US\\$23m to project management \(June 2026\)](#).

Roughly ten external commitments since 2016 account for [well over a billion dollars](#), and the Bank is [the largest single financier, with Chinese state lenders and contractors close behind](#). China Eximbank lent [RMB 1,736,207,810.54 on concessional terms for the national broadband network](#), under a framework agreement of January 2023 and a specific loan agreement that October. France arranged the largest European commitment, [€225,257,201 through Société Générale for the Earth-observation satellite programme, signed on 23 January 2025 and recorded as approved rather than disbursing](#). Alongside these sit [US\\$250 million for Projecto Njila across eight provinces from 2023, US\\$60 million for statistical capacity to 2027, an announced Cybastion and Angola Telecom investment in cybersecurity and a Luanda–Lobito cable \(June 2025\)](#), and from an earlier cycle a [US\\$66 million JBIC buyer's credit for the South Atlantic Cable System](#). Almost none of it is grant aid.

Connectivity has taken the largest share, ahead of identity and civil registration. Domestic appropriation is moving the other way: the named connectivity programme was [cut 30.5% to Kz 159.2 billion in the 2026 state budget](#) after rising from Kz 7.4 billion in 2024, with [the 4G expansion line down 42% to Kz 62.7 billion and the 3G coverage rubric deleted altogether](#).

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

Angola's mobile market is concentrated to the point where one operator's failure is close to a national one: [Unitel carried about 20.8 million customers in July 2026](#), and when its network went down at the end of that month [Africell was the only operator running fully](#).

The regulator's own series, reported to the ITU in November 2025, is the better-evidenced measure of reach: 55.50% of individuals used the internet in 2024, against 48.80% in 2023 and 42.10% in 2022, on 12,785,472 broadband subscriptions at 36.40% penetration and 26,407,932 mobile subscriptions at 75.19%, with national population coverage of 89.60% on 2G, 85.66% on 3G, 77.41% on 4G and 16.40% on 5G — 5G reaching only Luanda, Benguela and Huambo of the then eighteen provinces, and Luanda alone at 100% on 2G, 3G and 4G. The ministry's own figures run higher and on a different basis: it put the country above 28 million mobile subscriptions and above 17 million broadband users in March 2026, and Angola's mobile communications score rose 27.6 points over 2014–2023 to 69.1 out of 100, one of its ten most improved governance measures of the decade — while Angolans' own rating of the country's infrastructure, at 27.0 out of 100 in 2023, did not move over the same ten years.

The terrestrial fibre network connects every provincial and communal capital (May 2023), but the government conceded in June 2026 that weak internet and mobile coverage in hard-to-reach areas is the chief risk to completing the electoral register update, and the justice ministry attributed four months of outages at identification and civil registry posts across most of the country to telecommunications breakdowns (May 2026). An entry-level mobile broadband basket cost about 1.53% of gross national income per capita in 2024, inside the UN Broadband Commission's 2% target when measured against average national income.

International capacity keeps arriving. Unitel put US\$43 million into Angola's branch of the 2Africa cable and its landing station at Cacuaco, securing 23.6 Tbps of the cable's capacity for the country (December 2025), and a June 2026 agreement with Telecom Namibia and SATCAB gives Angola Telecom an initial 1.0 Tbps of Equiano capacity through Swakopmund. Yet used international bandwidth stood at 5.50 kbit/s per capita in November 2025, unchanged from the June 2024 baseline and against a project target of 10, and what would keep traffic local is thin: two active internet exchange points with 29 members between them in June 2026, present in one of the fourteen population centres above 300,000. The broadband programme has no free-standing plan of its own — it sits inside the ICT White Paper 2023–2027, brought into force by Presidential Decree 272/24 in December 2024, which expressly repealed the 2019–2022 White Paper and is where the country's broadband, data-centre, IXP, IPv6, spectrum and cybersecurity-institution programmes are set.

ANGOSAT-2 capacity was opened to commercial internet providers in December 2025, and 37 firms had entered the commercial arm of the Conecta Angola satellite project by April 2026. Every outcome indicator of the Digital Acceleration Project still read zero on 30 April 2026, against a contracted target of 13.5 million people brought to broadband by the project itself by March 2030.

Data Storage

Angolans' passports and education certificates, until then held on foreign platforms, moved onto national infrastructure under Angolan jurisdiction when the state opened its own data centre in April 2026.

The Data Center e Cloud do Governo at Camama in Luanda was inaugurated by President João Lourenço on 28 April 2026, and occupies 6,225 m² built to Tier III of the Uptime Institute classification, with 208 racks and 1,040 kW live. It was an US\$89 million project led by the state IT agency INFOSI with Presight and G42, hosting more than 80 government services on a single sovereign cloud as at April 2026, replicated by a secondary site and fibre-linked to the ministries of finance, telecommunications, interior, education and health, with public services facing a progressive and mandatory migration onto the national cloud it carries. The sovereignty this is presented as securing originates in a December 2021 memorandum between Angola and the United Arab Emirates, operationalised between the ministry and the Emirati firm Presight. The World Bank's 2025 GovTech assessment nonetheless records no whole-of-government cloud service and no government cloud policy for Angola.

Commercial capacity is thin and sits in Luanda. Raxio's AG1 at Cacuaco, opened in October 2025 as a US\$30 million investment, offers up to 3 MW and more than 800 racks on a 19,000 m² site near the undersea cable landings and is the country's only Tier III commercial facility; Paratus runs a three-centre campus in the city, and Africell built an enterprise data centre at its Luanda headquarters in 2021. There is no in-country hyperscale cloud region: the nearest AWS, Azure and Google Cloud regions are elsewhere in Africa (2024).

No broad data localisation requirement applies, though banking and oil and gas data is mostly hosted locally in practice, and personal data may cross the border only on an adequacy finding or authorisation from the data protection authority (2025). Financial institutions must notify the central bank and obtain its approval before contracting cloud or data-processing services, and disclose the hosting country; the data protection authority has fined firms for moving client data to cloud servers outside Angola without authorisation (June 2026).

Energy

Afrobarometer's 2023 survey found 14% of rural Angolans living in areas the national grid serves, against 92% of urban residents — a gap of some 78 percentage points, and the constraint that decides where a digital economy can actually run.

Nationally, 51.1% of the population had access to electricity in 2023, against 77.9% in urban areas. Angola's Access to Energy score reached 48.0 out of 100 in 2023, 20th of 54 African states, after rising 10.2 points over the decade to 2023 — improvement from a low floor rather than arrival. Generation is heavily hydro: hydropower supplied 88.5% of electricity output in 2020.

Off-grid provision is covered by a comprehensive policy framework spanning geospatial planning, subsidies, private-sector participation, mini-grids and standalone solar (2024). On the ground it is connectivity projects that carry their own power: Ilumina Angola reaches remote sites with shared towers, solar power and satellite backhaul, and Cubango's move to electronic provincial administration is planned around weak electricity as well as weak internet in its municipalities (December 2025).

Technical Capacity

Angola's identity and civil registration platforms run on foreign suppliers the state is locked into: the World Bank's 2024 diagnostic found limited domestic capacity and vendor lock-in to foreign suppliers — DGM Sistemas, HID Global and Unisys Africa on the civil registration and PGIBI platforms, with the Chinese state consultancy CEIEC on the PGIBI build — and recommended staff training and standard operating procedures to build in-country capability.

The same weakness shows in delivery. All but one of the technical activities of the Digital Acceleration Project were significantly delayed at April 2025, the exception being interoperability work, and the delay extended to the upstream technical studies meant to shape the investments downstream of them. The Bank raised both project ratings in June 2026 on improved collaboration between the participating institutions, while institutional capacity and stakeholder risk both stayed above their levels at approval.

UNESCO's readiness assessment, presented on 30 June 2026, named deficits in human capital and interministerial coordination alongside the absence of a national AI strategy. Inside government, the human resource management system for the public service is still being implemented rather than in use, and runs on commercial off-the-shelf software (2025), and Angola sat below the African average on the UN's e-government index in 2024.

Cybersecurity

Angola built a cybersecurity regulator by decree before it had a cybersecurity statute. [Presidential Decree 263/25](#), published on 10 December 2025, created the Centro Nacional de Cibersegurança as a public institute under the superintendence of the telecommunications minister, who may suspend or revoke its acts; its statute gives it regulation, rule-making, supervision, inspection and sanctioning powers, and the ability to issue binding circulars and instrutivos on the entities it supervises, and Article 25 leaves the Centro 30% of the receipts of the fines it levies, with 40% to the Treasury and 30% to a cybersecurity fund.

The operative statute remains [Law 7/17](#) on the protection of networks and computer systems, which imposes security and incident-notification duties on operators; the cybersecurity bill was adopted by the National Assembly on 12 August 2026 by 104 votes to 56 and is not yet promulgated, so it binds nobody; Angola's delegation to a regional forum on 29 July 2026 described the legislation as em fase de diagnóstico. CERT.ao exists as a department inside the Centro rather than as a separate agency, and the World Bank recorded no national CIRT established as at 30 April 2026. Designation of telecommunications as critical infrastructure, mandatory incident reporting and a national incident-response team were supplied by no instrument in force as at 10 August 2026. The one binding sectoral rule predates all of it and belongs to the central bank: [Aviso n.º 8/20](#) of 2 April 2020 sets the rules on cybersecurity policy and on the terms and conditions of contracting data-processing, data-storage and cloud-computing services for the institutions the bank supervises.

The bill's own design was contested before the vote. In January 2026 the national bar association told the National Assembly that the cybersecurity bill and the bill against false information should be read as a single package and both required integral reformulation, arguing that the proposed Centro Nacional de Cibersegurança would combine regulation, rule-making, supervision, inspection and sanction in one body in breach of the separation of powers, that article 15(1)(f)'s allowance of access to private communications on a "judicial or administrative" decision was constitutionally unacceptable and should require prior judicial authorisation, and that undefined terms — "cyber threat", "acts against state security" — invited arbitrary enforcement and a chilling effect on vulnerability research.

The test arrived on 28 July 2026, when Unitel lost mobile voice, data and internet nationwide from 02:20 to a cyberattack affecting more than 21 million customers, its fixed fibre and fixed-wireless services staying up. A first restoration was declared on 5 August 2026, nine days later, with card payment terminals among the channels lost, and the operator declared its core mobile services fully restored nationwide on 21 August 2026, with only the custom ringback-tone feature still offline and affected users receiving automatic invoice credits or additional service days. No attribution or attack vector had been established as at 31 July 2026 and no breach notification had been issued; on the scope of loss the operator states that a continuing forensic investigation with independent external experts has found no evidence of unauthorised access to or sharing of customer or partner personal data, which is its own account and not a regulator's finding. The attack landed in the week Unitel's shares were admitted to trading on the BODIVA exchange.

Angola scored 39.64 on the ITU's Global Cybersecurity Index in 2024, in its evolving tier — a score the National Cybersecurity Strategy cites as its own justification — and the 2026 state budget cut the appropriation for improving that position.

DPI

Data Exchange

Angola contracted the hardware for its interoperability layer in June 2026, eight years after approving the plan for it: the Instituto de Modernização Administrativa [signed a US\\$150m contract with TIS Tech Angola](#) on 17 June for the Projecto de Infra-estruturas Digitais Públicas, a twelve-month build [specified as the secure-zone host for the interoperability platform, PKI-based electronic signatures and digital identity](#). Presidential Decree 46/18 had [approved PNAGIA](#) in 2018. Implementation and the management of training were both put out to tender in February 2026 under the World Bank-financed digital acceleration project, [the platform set on a controlled data-reuse "once-only" principle against a diagnostic finding 27% of systems interconnected, with a separate consultancy for training the institutions that will use it](#).

What runs today is narrower: Angola [has a government interoperability framework and a Government Service Bus, the framework only partially used across public bodies \(2025\), with the electronic procurement system connected to other systems by direct interfaces and the bus. SEPE, the public services portal, works as a partial interoperability hub, and the identity platform is connected to civil registration, social security, the tax number, the electoral register, several banks and that portal \(2024\)](#).

The foundational registers are the gap. [Civil registration is not connected to the government's data-exchange platform, with insufficient interoperability between civil registration and identification named as a weakness for priority reform. A presidential decree of 8 June 2026 created an interministerial commission tasked with stabilising interoperability between the civil-identification database and the adult-citizen database. Kwenda, the main social protection programme, issues its own beneficiary identifier rather than using the national identity system, making cross-referencing against other government databases difficult \(2024\)](#).

What does cross is largely statutory and periodic. [The electoral register is populated from the national civil identification database by an annual computerised file; Law 13/19 requires civil registration to pass vital-event data on foreign citizens to the Immigration Authority; the identity card is generated from the birth-registration record through interoperability between the two systems. Financial messaging has moved faster: the central bank completed migration of domestic payments to ISO 20022 on 10 July 2026, covering EMIS, the BODIVA exchange and the SPTR settlement system. So has surveillance: a SITA advance passenger data system and monitoring centre are operational at Luanda's airport \(December 2025\), and the President approved about €552,000 for a licence sending Angolan financial-account data to the US Internal Revenue Service under FATCA \(June 2026\)](#).

Two 2025–26 instruments make exchange a condition of a decision rather than an aspiration. A single window launched in September 2025 has [a citizen lodge a land-concession file once at the municipal administration, the state then routing it through the tax authority, the geographic and cadastral institute and the property-registry conservatories. And in compulsory social protection, Presidential Decree 11/26 requires the managing entity's information exchange with other public and private institutions to observe national and international standards of interoperability, security and personal-data protection — a duty stated in statute for a system whose own registers are among those recorded as not connected](#).

Digital Identity and CRVS

[Just over half of Angola's population — 52.4% — held the Bilhete de Identidade at the 2024 census reference date, and the state is now legislating to make that card the only document that counts: a Council of Ministers bill of 29 April 2026 would make it the sole valid identification document, mandatory for banking, telecoms, school enrolment, property registration and contracts](#).

Holding is unevenly spread. 63% of urban residents held the card against 30.9% of rural residents (September 2024), and it rises steeply with age — 30% of those aged 5-14, 55% of those aged 15-24 and 66% of those aged 25 and over (2024).

Decreto Presidencial 169/25 opened a supplementary credit of USD 218,500,000 inside the enacted 2025 budget on 19 September 2025 for the universalisation plan launched by decree in November 2024. Production has been pushed out from the single Kilamba centre: all 21 provinces printed the card locally as at July 2026, and a home service launched on 28 July 2026 brings biometric capture to the house across Luanda province, at 250,000 kwanzas for processing and 10,000 for delivery alone. More than 120,000 issued cards sat uncollected in July 2026.

The credential is biometric, with ten fingerprints, photograph, signature and height captured at enrolment, but its chip cannot be used for digital authentication, because no public key infrastructure has been established, and there is no standalone digital identity law. The one quantified digital-identity target, 10 million people with digitally verifiable identification by March 2030, had a baseline of zero and stood at zero in April 2025. Procurement of the missing layer opened in August 2026: Despacho Presidencial 300/26 of 13 August authorised USD 28,000,000 and opened public tender for a National Digital Identity and Electronic Signatures Platform, specified to carry up to 30 million digital identities and to support identification, authentication and legally valid electronic signature. No supplier or delivery date is stated.

Underneath the card, the registration pipeline is thinner still. Only 39.2% of children aged 0-4 had their birth registered in 2024, up from 24.8% in 2014 — the newest cohort is the least registered. The 2023-24 demographic and health survey puts the same measure at 38% of children under five registered with the civil registry and 36% holding a birth certificate, independently corroborating the census and separating the two things the census counts as one: registration and the document that proves it are two percentage points apart. Most civil registration and identification records are still held in unindexed paper files. Nascer com Registo, run by three ministries with EU and UNICEF support, places registry posts inside maternity wards so newborns leave registered and carrying a first card; it began in Zaire province in October 2025 and was formally launched in March 2026.

Digital Payments and Fintech

The kwanza was introduced as a settlement currency in the SADC real-time gross settlement system on 27 July 2026, only the second in the system's history, which had cleared exclusively in rand since 2013. Angolan customers reach it indirectly, through five participating commercial banks, the central bank naming removal of the correspondent-banking layer as the gain.

Domestically the growth is on the instant rail. KWiK carried about 35 million transfers worth 590 billion kwanzas during 2025, more than doubling year on year, and Angola counted more than 12.3 million registered payment accounts and roughly 24.8 million active payment keys in February 2026. The rail is led by non-banks: Paypay handled 52.2% of KWiK transfers in February 2026, against 21.9% for Banco BAI and 12.6% for Unitel Money, leaving sixteen banks to share the rest, and 66.4% of that month's transfers were for less than 10,000 kwanzas. EMIS operates all of it — the Multicaixa ATM and POS network, five clearing systems and KWiK — built with the central bank, which requires all 22 banks and the mobile operators to join.

Fewer than one in five adults actively uses digital payments, about 31% hold a bank account and mobile money penetration is around 6% (2025). The identity card is a prerequisite for opening a bank account or obtaining a loan, which ties financial access to the register's incomplete coverage. Kwenda is the exception: it pays more than 1.6 million targeted households digitally through mobile money, simplified accounts and payment cards, and its programme card lets beneficiaries without an identity card open a bank or mobile account (2025). Afrimoney, launched in April 2023, sits alongside the bank-centric rails rather than replacing them.

The central bank regulates and oversees the system under Payment System Law 05/05 rather than operating retail systems itself, with payment services governed by Aviso 5/22 (2022) — a perimeter it has rebuilt twice since. Aviso 4/25 of 22 August 2025 set the rules for opening, operating and closing electronic-money accounts, defining four account types graded by how the holder proves identity and opening them to under-18s on a parental responsibility term, to non-resident foreigners with legal stay and to micro and small companies, and Aviso 1/26 of 28 January 2026 required every non-bank acquirer of payment terminals or ATMs to be a central-bank-authorised payment service provider, certified under the Multicaixa arrangement and holding a float account at a bank, bringing sub-acquirers under named risk, settlement and contractual-transparency duties. The value limits are set separately and the state exempts itself from them: Instrutivo n.º 02/2025 caps Multicaixa payments at Kz 30m a day, credit transfers at Kz 50m and direct debits at Kz 30m per operation, makes real-time gross settlement compulsory above Kz 50m, and then gives the finance ministry, the social-security institute and the central bank a Kz 99,999,999.99 per-operation Multicaixa ceiling and outright exemption from the transfer and direct-debit limits.

The central bank's own annual accounts put firmer numbers on the rail than the monthly operator reports do. KWiK carried Kz 590.36 thousand million across 35,000,724 transfers in 2025, up 725.4% in value and 1,116.69% in number on a 2024 base of Kz 71.53 thousand million and 2,876,721 operations, with 23,974,751 accounts registered in the addressing module at year end and an average transfer of about Kz 17,000; the same report sets the whole payment system at more than 3,535 million operations worth Kz 463.72 biliões and records the effective end of the cheque, 4,989 items cleared against 38,664 in 2024. How much rests on how little showed in July: a cyberattack on Unitel from 02:20 on 28 July 2026 still had card terminals unreliable in Luanda shops and filling stations four days later, with queues at ATMs as people drew cash to transact.

Registries

Angola launched its single social registry in July 2026 — the social affairs ministry's Cadastro Social Único, to map vulnerable households and direct social supports — seven years after Presidential Decree 136/19 established it.

The largest register is the electoral one, being rebuilt ahead of 2027. The update targets 16,707,455 citizens and runs from 15 June 2026 to 31 March 2027 through the Balcão Único counter network, of which 254 of a planned 634 were live across all 21 provinces at the opening. The President ordered a \$275 million supplementary credit in the 2026 budget for the Ministry of Territorial Administration (February 2026). At the last outing the roll recorded 14,399,391 voters against a voting-age population of 15,939,218 (August 2022), with African Union observers reporting deceased persons on it.

The tie to the identity card varies. Presidential Decree 245/21 makes a citizen's taxpayer number identical to their identity card number, while foreign residents and legal entities take sequential numbers from the tax authority. The undocumented must obtain an identity card before they can join the electoral base, which makes the card the gate to the vote. The tie is being made total by statute: under the 2025 official electoral registration law, in-person registration is replaced by automatic enrolment drawn from the civil identity database, and the voter card is used for the last time in 2027, after which the identity card is the sole registration credential. Angola operates no independent biometric electoral registration, and the roll has never been through a comprehensive independent technical audit.

On land, the digital cadastre covers all 18 provincial offices, with more than 450,000 urban parcel boundaries mapped and about 100,000 properties registered (2025); the SIRP property registration system is installed in all 22 registry offices, coverage concentrated in urban areas. The Executive set a target of legalising 40,000 properties by end-2026 through a platform linking the land institute, the tax authority and the property registry (April 2026). On business, the Guiché Único da Empresa issues a taxpayer number as part of incorporation, alongside commercial

registration and social security enrolment, and logged more than 14,000 company constitutions in 2026. The nominal worker register RENT is live and rolling out province by province (2025), while a national farmer and producer registry is still being tendered.

A separate population base sits outside all this: Lei 11/20 puts the identity of suspects and victims, the offender's biometric data, social and medico-pathological history and criminal record into a database managed by the criminal police.

Sectoral management information systems

Electronic invoicing became mandatory in Angola on 1 January 2026 for large taxpayers and suppliers to the state, with invoices issued from software certified by the tax authority, transmitted in real time and carrying a verification code, on SAF-T as the data standard; 51,245 large taxpayers and state suppliers had joined by 23 August 2026, having issued 36,341,801 electronic invoices at a daily run-rate of about 400,000 through 255 certified software packages, on the collector's own figures; the obligation reaches general and simplified-regime VAT taxpayers only from 2027. The tax administration behind it is the state's most complete: AGT runs SIGT, a centralised real-time online tax system, SAF-T accounting filings have been mandatory since 2019, and it is integrating with SIGFE so that electronic invoices are validated automatically before the state pays a supplier (2026).

Public financial management thins out away from the centre. SIGFE has been rolled out to 164 municipalities, but roughly 40% of them have internet gaps that limit its use (2024). Presidential Decree 194/25 of 21 October 2025 established an integrated management system for the public investment programme, designed to share data with SIGFE, SIP and SIMAPE. A government payroll system is in use while the public-service HR management system it would draw on is still being implemented.

The line ministries' systems reach the province but not the point of service. The health ministry has run DHIS2 nationally since 2015, but at aggregation level: paper records from clinics are compiled and entered at municipal or provincial offices rather than captured digitally at the facility. Electronic medical records are confined to a small number of urban facilities in Luanda and rural clinics record consultations, vaccinations and treatments on paper. Education runs the same way: SIGE is operational and supplies the statistics institute, with the vocational system SIETP integrated into it in 2025, while rural primary schools keep attendance, enrolment and grades on paper for aggregation at provincial or district level.

Customs runs a commercial off-the-shelf system, and a social insurance and pension system runs on a hybrid of custom and commercial software (2025). Social protection delivery remains nascent: the Cadastro Social Único is being linked to the Kwenda management information system and the welfare ministry's SIGAS registry, with digitisation low and interoperability limited (2024).

Other GovTech and e-Gov

Angola's official electronic services portal listed seven services in August 2026, all free: a taxpayer-number lookup, a weather forecast, an electricity ombudsman contact, airport arrivals and departures, a commercial-licence lookup, an online CV and the complaints book. None of them completes an administrative transaction end to end: nothing on the list files an application, pays a fee or issues a document. No take-up figure is published for any of them.

The portal is not a census of what the state does online, and the partly transactional migration and traffic services do not appear on it. Digitising passport, driving-licence and vehicle-document services at the migration service and the traffic directorate in mid-2025 ended the queues and the informal "mixeiros" fixer economy at their doors. The tax authority runs its own taxpayer portal and mobile app; the Guiché Único launched an upgraded business-formalisation platform in April 2025; the electronic procurement system publishes both tender notices and awarded

contracts; and the state payment reference system RUPE, run by EMIS, accounts for 36% of the state's current revenues and takes tax and fees at bank counters, ATMs, POS terminals, online and by mobile (2025). Angola scored 0.4149 on the UN E-Government Development Index in 2024, 156th of 193 member states and below the African average.

Coordination sits with the Instituto de Modernização Administrativa under the Casa Civil, which runs the Agenda de Transição Digital da Administração Pública — 218 structuring projects across six objectives and seven axes (March 2026). The legal base has not kept pace. A digital government framework bill entered public consultation on 6 May 2026, put forward expressly to end the scattering of technology rules across separate instruments since 1997. There is still no dedicated legal regime for electronic signatures, digital certification or public key infrastructure; Parliament approved the President's request for authorisation to legislate one on 30 July 2026, by 166 votes with none against. Meanwhile the procurement runs ahead of the law: Despacho Presidencial 11/26 of 13 January 2026 authorised Kz 8.6bn for Microsoft licences covering the whole public administration, bought centrally by the IMA.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

Cubango approved an integrated document and archive management system for its own provincial administration, to run from January 2026, together with a citizen app for submitting proposals and following public tenders — a province buying a system rather than hosting one. That distinction carries most of the story. Identity-card printing now runs in every province, but it is a national issuance function moved onto provincial premises rather than a provincial system; the same holds for the electoral-register proof-of-life operation, which runs through the national Balcão Único counter network across all 21 provinces (June 2026) on a budget the President reinforced for the Ministry of Territorial Administration (February 2026), and for Projecto Njila, coordinated by that ministry across eight provinces and dozens of municipalities (2023).

The system that does reach the municipal tier is the financial one: SIGFE has been rolled out to municipal administrations, and internet gaps in many of them limit its use (2024) — the local state's own accounting runs on a national system whose weak point is the connectivity everything else is also waiting on. Beyond it the sub-national footprint is thin and mostly judicial: the Ombudsman's virtual hearings have expanded to municipalities in several provinces, within a judicial digitisation effort still at an intermediate phase and needing legislative and technical consolidation (2026). The one local operational system being built out beyond the capital is a surveillance one. Alongside the national police's five new command-and-control centres in Luanda's urban municipalities (2024), the interior ministry is installing Integrated Public Security Centres province by province: Cabinda was inaugurated as the fifth on 9 December 2025, with a 24-hour command and video-surveillance room answering the 111 emergency number, 184 cameras carrying facial recognition, number-plate reading and protection of designated strategic state sites, and 180 staff, and a sixth was begun in Saurimo, Lunda-Sul, on 30 July 2026 with more than 100 cameras on the city's main arteries in a first phase, the centres' director-general saying the expansion is under way in almost every province and is meant to move policing from the traditional model to one built on technology. No data-protection basis, retention rule or supervisory authority is named for any of that estate.

Rural digital data capture

The Ilumina Angola programme reached Lago Dilolo, a Moxico locality of 40,882 people, in June 2026, carrying voice and data there over national roaming, shared towers and antennas, solar power and ANGOSAT-2 backhaul; what happens at the counter in places like it is still written down by hand. Rural primary healthcare clinics record consultations, vaccinations and treatments on paper registers at the point of care, with unreliable power and connectivity, staff shortages and thin IT training behind it (2025). Electronic medical records run in a handful of

Luanda facilities and have not been extended to rural clinics (2025). Rural primary schools keep attendance, enrolment and grades on paper, and the data enters the national education management system only at provincial or district level (2026) — the school itself is not a point of capture.

Power and connectivity are the binding constraints, and government plans say so. Cubango's move from analogue to electronic provincial administration is designed around weak internet and electricity supply in municipalities such as Mavengue (December 2025). Rural households are far less likely than urban ones to live where the electricity grid reaches (2023). Fibre reaches every provincial and communal capital, which is a different claim from service in the municipality around it, and the government has said plainly that [weak internet and mobile coverage in hard-to-reach areas is the chief risk to completing the electoral-register update](#) (June 2026).

Where capture is arriving, it arrives with a donor project attached: [Njila has been equipping birth-registration posts with computers since 2023, with posts coming into service from August 2025, mostly at maternal and child health centres](#). What that works against is visible in the census, where [identity-card holding among rural residents runs far below the urban rate](#) (2024), and in [digital public services still concentrated in Luanda](#) (2024).

Technology

AI

Angola's draft artificial-intelligence law creates a right to an explanation of, and to refuse, AI-based decisions, and then [leaves the competent AI authority to a future regulation](#) — no body is identified to vindicate those rights, nothing in the text assigns them to the data protection agency, and the bill repeals no existing legislation, so it lands on top of Law 22/11 and Lei n.º 11/20 with the interactions unstated.

The bill runs to 86 articles in nine chapters and was published for public consultation on the telecommunications ministry's portal in September 2025, claiming extraterritorial reach over AI activity conducted outside Angola that affects Angolan interests, and carrying privacy and personal-information duties, rights over intellectual property in AI-generated content and protections for digitally disadvantaged groups. Its architecture is not the European one: a [single "IA Crítica" class](#) carrying registration, security-risk assessment, disclosure and emergency-response duties stands in place of a tiered risk pyramid, the promotion-and-development chapter sits ahead of the rights chapter, and the state is put on the supply side with duties to build national computing infrastructure and release public data. [No dedicated artificial-intelligence law is in force](#).

UNESCO's readiness assessment, presented on 30 June 2026, found 50.9 per cent of its indicators fully met, 32.7 per cent partially met and 16 per cent insufficient, and named the missing national AI strategy as the principal gap, alongside deficits in human capital and interministerial coordination. Deployment runs well behind the drafting: inside government, [the tax authority has had an artificial-intelligence risk-analysis system in test to target non-compliant taxpayers](#) (2026), and the only binding-looking commitment elsewhere is not binding — [a presidential decree of 16 April 2026 approving a road-safety cooperation protocol with Portugal names the dematerialisation, automation and use of artificial-intelligence methodologies in the contraordenação process as an area of cooperation, while its clause 7 states the protocol is a declaration of mutual intent creating no legally binding obligations](#).

The consultation the bill was published into has stayed open for a year without producing a law. As at 27 August 2026 the ministry's portal [still carries the September 2025 draft and records 18 contributions from companies, 18 from specialists and 5 from the general public](#). What the state is buying in the meantime is governance rather than

legislation: in March 2026 the modernisation institute [tendered a consultancy for a governance framework for digital government and for artificial intelligence in the public sector](#), financed through the digital acceleration project — an instrument distinct from the bill, with no published scope, drafter or timetable beyond its terms of reference.

ICT Industry

The largest event in Angola's technology sector in 2026 was a share sale rather than a product: [a 15 per cent state stake in Unitel went under the PROPRIV privatisation programme for Kz 300.3 billion, reported as about US\\$329m, oversubscribed by more than 20 per cent across 17,549 accepted orders, with the shares appreciating more than 24 per cent on debut to about Kz 50,000 a share on 30 July 2026](#). That is the shape of the sector: the state selling a minority of [the operator that dominates the mobile market](#) into a domestic exchange, with the listing itself the main new market discipline on it. When [a cyberattack took the same operator's mobile network down the day before trading opened](#), the company framed its disclosure as a listed-company obligation to keep the market and investors [informed](#) — the reporting duty that bit was securities law, not telecoms or cyber regulation.

Government demand goes mostly to foreign vendors. [CEIEC and Huawei are the contractors for Phase 2 of Angola's Public Security Project surveillance network \(2021\)](#), and there is no government programme for engaging GovTech startups or the private technology sector in [building public digital services \(2025\)](#) — so the domestic sector has no route into the state's own build. The conditions it trades under are among the country's worst: [Business and Labour Environment is Angola's second-worst governance sub-category at 31.1 out of 100 in 2023, 49th of 54 African states, though business and competition regulation within it rose 14.3 points to 51.1](#).

The one segment opening to local firms is satellite. [ANGOSAT-2 capacity was released to commercial providers in December 2025](#) after years reserved for government, and [a startup based in Moxico province was licensed by the regulator to sell internet access over it in July 2026](#).

Innovation ecosystem

Angola's first significant domestic venture capital vehicle for technology startups is [the Kimbo Fund, run by BFA Asset Management and seeded with USD 5 million by the sovereign wealth fund FSDEA in 2024](#) — a first, at a size that says how thin the domestic financing layer still is.

Capital of any scale comes from outside it. [Anda, an Angolan mobility and fintech startup, has raised from Breega, Speedinvest, 4DX Ventures and the French development finance institution Proparco \(2026\)](#), and ecosystem mapping names technology hubs including [Disruption Lab, Acelera Angola and Bantu Makers](#) as where such firms are incubated. On the output side, [Angola ranked 138th on WIPO's Global Innovation Index in 2025, in the bottom quartile](#).

Absorption by the state is the weaker half. The finance ministry has [a public-finance innovation laboratory, i.Lab, launched in March 2026](#), but across government [public sector innovation is assessed as a strategy or programme only rather than an established institutional arrangement \(2025\)](#) — a stated intention to innovate, without the standing machinery that would carry it between ministries or outlast the programme that announced it.

Capacity

Literacy

Education is [Angola's worst-scoring sub-category in the 2024 Ibrahim Index of African Governance](#), at 29.4 out of 100 in 2023 and 50th of 54 African states, after a rise of only 2.4 points over the decade to 2023. The measures beneath it move in different directions: [Education Enrolment fell 8.4 points over the same decade to 37.7, ranking](#)

32nd, one of the ten most deteriorated measures in the country's whole profile, while Education Completion sits at 26.4 (36th) and Education Quality at 30.7 (38th). What schooling there is remains [unevenly distributed across the population](#).

The floor is much higher in the capital than those national scores imply. [Literacy among Luanda residents aged 15 and over is 94.5% \(February 2026\)](#), which places the obstacle to using a public digital service in the capital somewhere other than reading. The schools generating the national numbers still run on paper: [attendance, enrolment, grades and administrative records in rural primary schools are kept by hand and aggregated into the national education management information system at provincial or district level \(2026\)](#) rather than captured at the school itself. Connectivity has started to reach pupils ahead of that digitisation — [nearly 4,000 students in Ramiros were connected over ANGOSAT-2 and TV White Space in July 2026](#). For adults, the main standing effort is [Cidadão Digital](#), a digital financial literacy programme run by EMIS with the central bank.

Training and skills

The 2024 Ibrahim Index cannot score Angola on its teaching workforce at all: [Human Resources in Education is one of only two of the index's 96 indicators for which the country returns no data for 2023](#). Provision inside the state is at an early stage on the same evidence — the World Bank's GovTech Maturity Index recorded digital-skills training for public servants in 2025 as [a strategy or programme rather than an established institutional function](#), covering basic digital skills and data literacy through freely available material.

The domestic tertiary pipeline in computing is small and named: [Universidade Agostinho Neto's engineering and natural sciences faculties](#), [ISPTEC's MSc in computer science covering cybersecurity and software engineering](#), and [UniLuanda's INSTIC](#) are the established ICT degree programmes. A [UNESCO readiness assessment reported in June 2026](#) put the availability of a STEM-qualified workforce among the country's weaker points. The vocational side has at least become visible to the statistical system, with [the vocational education system SIETP integrated with the education management information system in 2025](#).

Most of the training capacity now being added arrives attached to a supplier or a lender rather than to a public institution. Angola runs an [ICT skills training partnership with Huawei working to a 2027 target](#); skills development is one of the three arms of the [World Bank's Angola Digital Acceleration Project](#), and people trained is one of its [2030 outcome targets](#). Cybersecurity training with the Cisco Networking Academy was announced as part of [the Cybastion–Angola Telecom package in June 2025](#), and cybersecurity training also sits inside [the Angola–Namibia ICT memorandum signed at ANGOTIC 2026](#). The regulator itself has been on the receiving end: Portugal's ANACOM, working with the EU Delegation, [ran an institutional-strengthening mission in March 2026 to train INACOM in digital-sector regulation](#).

Research institutions

The most concrete research commitment of the year is in space science: [GGPEN and Nigeria's National Space Research and Development Agency signed a space-science cooperation agreement at ANGOTIC 2026 in Luanda on 13 June 2026](#). The domestic base that would carry such work is narrow, resting on the same few institutions that teach computing — [Universidade Agostinho Neto](#), [ISPTEC](#) and [UniLuanda's INSTIC](#). Corporate research presence remains prospective: [Huawei stated on 2 October 2025, after an audience with President João Lourenço, that it intends to establish a research and development centre in Angola by 2027](#) aimed at digital inclusion, education, health and connectivity.

Inclusion

Access to services

Angola delivers services no more equally after a decade of digitisation: its equal-access-to-public-services score was 30.6 out of 100 in 2023, 36th of 54 African states and slightly lower than in 2014. The gate in front of most of those services is the identity card, whose coverage is incomplete: it is a prerequisite for opening a bank account, and required for the social register behind the Kwenda cash transfer, for education enrolment and for municipal services.

Where a service is designed around the people it must reach, it works. Kwenda reached more than a million households by 2026, and beneficiaries with disabilities receive a Multicaixa-linked payment card alongside assistive items such as wheelchairs, with community workers delivering benefits to the homes of those who cannot travel to distribution points (2025). Free connectivity has gone to named institutions rather than to the general public: Conecta Angola had delivered 32 public access points and connected six universities by June 2026, more than 5,600 University of Namibe students were given free internet over ANGOSAT-2 in June 2026, and satellite capacity with TV White Space connected 3,972 students in Ramiros in July 2026.

Elsewhere the digital channel moves the obstacle rather than removing it. Digitising passport, driving-licence and vehicle-document services in mid-2025 cleared the crowds and the informal "mixeiros" fixer economy from the doors of the migration service and the traffic directorate, but users could not follow the steps for a first driving licence on the traffic portal, and documents still arrived slowly after the digital application (November 2025).

Access that runs over one network is only as reliable as that network. The Unitel outage cut off ride-hailing, balance checks and payments for several days in August 2026, pushing subscribers onto Africell and Movitel and slowing those networks too, and nine days after detection small-business owners were still counting the cost, bookings by phone and payments by card terminal both severed, customers learning of it through other channels rather than from the operator. The government's own financial-inclusion measure sat well short of its 2027 target in the first quarter of 2026.

Digital divides

Weak internet and mobile coverage in hard-to-reach areas is the government's stated chief risk to completing the electoral-register update (June 2026) — the divide has stopped being a development statistic and become a constraint on the franchise.

The instrument meant to close it dates from November 2010 and obliges nobody to publish what it does. The Fundo de Apoio ao Desenvolvimento das Comunicações rests on a presidential decree rather than a statute, and is funded from a standing annual levy on the private sector: the decree sets it at 1% of the gross revenue of public telecommunications operators and service providers, alongside a share of the regulator INACOM's receipts, with its priority areas left to ministerial despacho. Its grants are reserved for non-commercial expansion into underserved areas, it is barred from subsidising operating costs, and it carries no publication obligation beyond accounts homologated by the finance minister.

The divide it exists to address is measured repeatedly, and always along the same line. Angola's digital public services are concentrated in Luanda, with digital literacy and physical infrastructure the documented barriers across rural areas (2024). Every other measure that splits by settlement splits the same way: identity-card holding falls off sharply between urban and rural residents, birth registration is markedly higher in towns, registered property parcels are a small fraction of those mapped and cluster in urban areas, and rural residents live overwhelmingly

outside the reach of the electricity grid everything else depends on. Where the exclusion is not geographic it is administrative: near-universal adult literacy in Luanda means the province's own documentation gap cannot be explained by schooling.

Schooling is nonetheless where Angola ranks worst on the divides that feed everything else. Its equality-in-education score was 30.7 out of 100 in 2023, 47th of 54 African states, and that is after a rise of more than nine points across the decade to 2023. Language runs alongside it: national languages other than Portuguese are widely spoken, which drives the multilingual requirement on broadcast and public-information services.

Data

National statistics

Angola's weakest point in official statistics is the collection of the data itself: across the five pillars of the World Bank's Statistical Performance Indicators the country sits in the 70-89% band for data use and data products, the 50-69% band for data services and infrastructure, and only the 20-49% band for data sources (2023).

That is not for want of censuses. A population census, an agricultural census and a business census were all conducted within the preceding ten years (2023), and the definitive results of the 2024 population census were published in November 2025, confirming Luanda as the province concentrating the largest share of the population. The survey programme is more uneven: three or more business surveys and three or more labour surveys over the decade, but only two household surveys and two health surveys, and no agricultural survey at all – the one survey type recorded as missing entirely (2023).

Administrative systems are not yet a substitute for that collection. The health ministry's DHIS2 platform runs at the aggregation level, with paper records from clinics compiled and entered at municipal or provincial offices (2025); most civil registration and identification records remain in unindexed paper files (2024), a position a 2021 assessment traced to the absence of civil registration infrastructure in rural areas. The education system SIGE does feed the National Statistics Institute directly, and absorbed the vocational system in 2025.

The share of Angolan businesses on the tax register is not established: INE's business census counted around 83,700 enterprises, roughly two thirds of them formal (2026). Other basic measures have simply stopped: international internet bandwidth per user was last measured in 2015, and the Ibrahim Index leaves Angola unscored for human resources in education for want of reported data (2023). A UNESCO readiness assessment scored the country's data governance at 47 out of 100 (June 2026), and a World Bank programme running to 2027 is funding modernisation of the statistical system and INE's own capacity; its first component opened on 16 September 2025 as an inventory and evaluation of the administrative data already held across the public administration, with Statistics Portugal offering its national data infrastructure and the simplified business return that let it retire its own annual business survey – the route by which the collection gap above would be closed without new field operations.

The institute doing that work was restated in law in March 2026. Presidential Decree 43/26 revokes the 2017 organic statute and re-establishes INE as the national statistical authority with technical, administrative, financial and patrimonial autonomy under the superintendence of the ministerial department responsible for planning, writing technical independence, neutrality, impartiality, confidentiality and transparency into the text and reorganising it into five executive directorates plus local services. Its census products carry their own quality apparatus and their own unexplained gap: a coverage survey of the 2024 census was published in November 2025, and the Luanda provincial report closing the series in February 2026 puts the province at 8,665,510 people and puts Cacuaco at 875,071 where INE's own national synthesis puts it at 1,025,859, the other fifteen municipalities matching to the person and no reason for the 150,787 given.

Open data

Angola has [no open data portal](#), and the sub-indicators covering what such a portal would publish are recorded as [not applicable in consequence](#) in the World Bank's 2025 GovTech assessment. One is now committed rather than merely absent: the digital acceleration project's safeguards plan records [Component 2 undertaking to create a shared data-governance framework, shared infrastructure, an open-data portal and electronic services](#) — a commitment recited in a safeguards instrument rather than in a data policy of its own, with nothing published as operating.

The absence is of a piece with the rest. The documentation behind most of the country's assessed government systems, strategies and oversight functions — [the interoperability framework, the tax and procurement systems, the national service portal, the digital government mandate, the digital transformation strategy and the data protection authority's reporting](#) — is held internally and not published (2025). The Ibrahim Index puts the same split in numbers: [34.8 out of 100 for the accessibility of public records](#), 20th of 54 African states, against [16.5 for the disclosure of those records](#), 44th of 54 and up only 2.7 points over the decade to 2023.

Among published statistics, coverage and openness are strongest on the external accounts — [balance of payments and international trade each score 6 out of 10](#) on Open Data Watch's Open Data Inventory (2024) — and weakest on the environment and prices, with [pollution at 2.5 and agriculture, energy and price statistics each at 3](#). [Social statistics fall between 3 and 4.5](#), population, poverty, health and education outcomes among them.

There is a [right to information law that the GovTech assessment rates as in force and effective](#) rather than adopted and dormant; it is [Lei n.º 11/02 of 16 August 2002, the Lei de Acesso aos Documentos Administrativos](#), and no implementing regulation, oversight body or request statistics under it is published. What is published is not always sound: [Novo Jornal found surplus zeros in the telecoms ministry's 2025 procurement plan and reported on 21 February 2025 that the document had still not been corrected](#). Publication is firmer in procurement generally, where the [electronic system publishes both tender notices and awarded contracts \(2025\)](#), and outside government altogether: [Multicaixa runs a public statistics portal carrying monthly terminal counts, transaction volumes and values by channel \(2026\)](#). Where openness meets personal data the answer has gone the other way — in June 2026 the National Assembly [rejected a bill that would have opened the electoral registers and citizen databases to parties and voters](#), on privacy grounds.

Use of satellite data

Angola's Earth-observation capability is being built rather than used: the [ANGE0-1 contract, worth about €225m, was formally launched at Toulouse on 16 March 2026](#) by GGPEN's director-general and Airbus, framed by the government as securing sovereign access to critical Earth-observation data. The satellite is [being built by Airbus Defence and Space at Toulouse on the S250 optical platform](#); the programme [passed its System Key Point milestone on 14 May 2026](#), confirming the design against Angola's requirements, with the first ground infrastructure due from June 2026.

The imagery is intended for [soil and agriculture, urban mapping, environmental monitoring, mining, oil and gas, and border control](#) (March 2026). GGPEN, which [runs both the ANGOSAT communications satellites and the ANGE0 Earth-observation programme](#), is already marketing downstream services from it — [imagery with geospatial analysis for infrastructure monitoring, asset registers and land-use mapping, through its GEDAE geodata centre \(June 2026\)](#). What the state is spending is now published at a plausible order of magnitude: the ministry's [corrected 2025 procurement plan puts satellite construction and launch at Kz 712.7 milhões and the Earth-observation system at Kz 77.7 milhões](#), the latter reclassified as a new contract (March 2025).

The working use of geospatial data meanwhile sits on the ground, in the [digital cadastre the national geographic and cadastral institute has deployed across its provincial offices \(2025\)](#). Angola's other satellite activity is connectivity, not observation: [ANGOSAT-2 is operated from the Funda Mission Control Centre and its capacity opened to commercial internet providers in December 2025](#); [Eutelsat holds a 15-year licence for OneWeb low-earth-orbit service, the only licensed LEO operator, with a Luanda ground station \(June 2025\)](#), and took a [multi-year capacity agreement with the Angolan provider Mercury Telecom in June 2026](#). The cooperation signed around [ANGOTIC 2026](#) — with [Nigeria's space agency](#), with [Mozambique, whose Boane earth station already receives the ANGOSAT-2 signal](#), and with [Telecom Namibia](#) — sits on that same side.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

Angolan financial-account data goes to the US Internal Revenue Service under a bilateral tax agreement, for which a presidential order of 8 June 2026 approved about €552,000 in [software licensing under Angola's FATCA agreement with the United States](#).

The largest American commercial position is Cybastion's, and it is still a framework: the firm's partnership with Angola Telecom rests on a [memorandum of understanding signed at Mobile World Congress in Barcelona in March 2025](#), and the package [announced that June at the US–Africa Business Summit in Luanda](#) — a national cybersecurity agency, Cisco Networking Academy training and a [Luanda–Lobito undersea cable](#) — remains an announcement against it, which would put one American commercial actor inside both the cyber-institution build and the connectivity build.

Where American suppliers are already embedded is the public administration's software: a presidential despacho of January 2026 authorised the [central procurement of Microsoft licences for the whole of public administration](#) through the IMA, replacing per-institution buying with a single commitment to one foreign vendor's licensing stack. On the network side, Angola Cables extended its Atlantic wholesale backbone in May 2026 through a partnership with Uniti Wholesale that [gives it reach across a 386,000 km US fibre network](#), adding to its SACS, MONET and WACS routes.

[Starlink was not licensed to operate in Angola](#), with its licensing still in progress, in the position the Secretary of State for Telecommunications stated on 3 August 2026. Angola took its digital transition agenda, then numbering 214 structuring projects, to the [World Bank's Digital Summit in Washington in March 2025](#).

China activities

The platform that carries civil identity in Angola was built by a Chinese state consultancy, and the state cannot yet run it alone: the World Bank's 2024 diagnostic found [limited domestic capacity and vendor lock-in, with the PGIBI build tied to the Chinese state consultancy CEIEC](#) and staff training and standard operating procedures recommended to build capability in country.

A presidential despacho of January 2017 [selected the state-owned CEIEC to implement the Plataforma de Gestão Integrada da Identificação Civil e Criminal](#), contracted through the Ministry of Justice and Human Rights and framed against a Chinese commercial credit line, and the civil registration system has [run on Chinese-devised technology since 2020](#). The [national BI production centre at Kilamba](#), opened in November 2019, is where that platform meets the public.

The same contractors run the security build. [CEIEC and Huawei implement Phase 2 of the Public Security Project](#), the CCTV network in Luanda and the provincial centres together with the integrated centres that monitor what it collects, for which [China Eximbank approved a commercial loan in December 2021](#). China Eximbank is also the concessional lender behind the [National Broadband Network](#), under a framework agreement of January 2023 and a [loan agreement that October](#), with [Sinohydro](#) as implementing contractor for terrestrial fibre, a submarine line to Cabinda and modernisation of the core network.

Huawei's position has since widened past equipment. It [signed an agreement with the health ministry in 2026 for the progressive digitisation of hospitals](#) covering telemedicine and artificial intelligence, it runs an [ICT skills training partnership with the government](#), and after an audience with President Lourenço on 2 October 2025 its director-general for Portuguese-speaking countries said the firm [intends to establish a research and development centre in Angola](#).

EU activities

ANGEO-1, Angola's first national Earth-observation satellite, [passed its System Key Point milestone with Airbus on 14 May 2026](#), confirming the design against Angola's requirements. The contract had been [formally launched at Toulouse on 16 March 2026 by GGPEN's director-general Zolana João and Airbus](#), which is [building the satellite at Toulouse on its S250 optical platform](#), and the government presents it as securing sovereign access to critical Earth-observation data. The money is European as well as the manufacturing: a [€225,257,201 financing package arranged through Société Générale, signed at the Angola–France Economic Forum on 23 January 2025](#).

Travel documents sit with a European supplier too. Angola awarded a [USD 139 million ten-year biometric passport contract to the Hungary-based ANY Security Printing Company](#), financed under an agreement sealed in 2023.

EU money itself is in registration rather than infrastructure. [Nascer com Registo](#), EU-funded and UNICEF-supported and run by the justice, health and social action ministries, places registry posts inside maternity wards so that newborns leave registered and issued a first Bilhete de Identidade; it began in Zaire province in October 2025 and was formally launched at Mbanza Kongo on 4 March 2026.

Three smaller European positions complete the picture: [Eutelsat holds a 15-year licence to operate OneWeb low-earth-orbit connectivity](#) with a ground station in Luanda, the only licensed LEO operator in the country (June 2025); Portugal's regulator ANACOM ran an [institutional-strengthening mission with the EU Delegation in March 2026 to train INACOM in digital-sector regulation](#); and the French development finance institution Proparco is among the [investors in the Angolan mobility and fintech startup Anda](#), alongside Breega, Speedinvest and 4DX Ventures.

Gulf/UAE activities

Angola's [government data centre and national cloud was inaugurated by President Lourenço in April 2026](#), led by INFOSI and built with the Abu Dhabi companies Presight and G42, and the government presents it as an assertion of digital sovereignty.

What it is built to came from Abu Dhabi as well. The national cloud [originates in a memorandum of understanding signed in December 2021 between the governments of Angola and the United Arab Emirates](#), operationalised between the Emirati firm Presight and MINTTICS, and its agreed heads were a three-year digitalisation master plan for Angola, public-private partnerships, build-operate-transfer and other financing channels, digital skills and workforce development for Angolan youth, and further projects of mutual interest. The master plan the sovereign cloud answers to was therefore a deliverable of the Gulf partner that went on to build it, and the financing head the two governments agreed was build-operate-transfer. A memorandum binds neither side to spend, and the [Presight relationship rests on one](#).

India activities

India's USD 200 million credit line to Angola, announced at the New Delhi state visit of 3 May 2025, is for [modernisation of the armed forces](#), not for digital systems; alongside it, and with no figure attached, Prime Minister Modi said India would share its capabilities in digital public infrastructure, space technology and capacity building. That offer [carries no vendor, no figure, no signed instrument and no timetable, and no Aadhaar or MOSIP deployment exists for Angola](#), with India's own Secretary (Economic Relations) describing digital public infrastructure as a new area for Angola needing awareness building.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	2026-09-05
CURRENT EDITION	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/AGO/AGO-status.html
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/AGO/AGO-status-2026-09-05.pdf
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